THE OASIS

A Return to the Self

Nils Föge

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“To your tired eyes I bring a vision of a different world,
so new and clean and fresh you will forget the pain and sorrow
that you saw before. Yet this a vision is
which you must share with everyone you see,
for otherwise you will behold it not.”

from: A Course in Miracles

Disclaimer

The following reflections arise not from any ideology but from a deep inquiry into body, mind, and human nature. They invite the reader to reexamine familiar paths. The therapeutic approach described here is the result of a ten-year spiritual crisis and an inner state of emergency in which no conventional method offered support. I was forced to develop a new system capable of regulating and harmonizing the extreme physiological, psychological, and spiritual changes that such a process can generate.

This is not about miracle cures or dogma, but about rediscovering natural principles that operate within all of us and form the foundation of our innate self-healing capacity. Through these, individuals are empowered to take responsibility for their own process of regeneration.

The term *healing* is not useful in the context of a spiritual crisis, as it implies damage that must be repaired. This often leads to unrealistic expectations and a striving for a better future state that distracts from embracing the present moment. To avoid this, we speak of *integration*. Integration emphasizes an ongoing process of embodiment and reorganization without assuming a defective starting point. It is less about changing things and more about transforming our relationship to them and the way we see them. This orientation creates space in which problematic aspects can become meaningful components of personal development.

For inquiries or interest in collaboration, write to: nfoege@zohomail.eu

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Who We Are

The Oasis is a therapeutic community and a message of hope for a world increasingly engulfed by darkness. In a time when many people feel lost and alienated, we offer a safe space in which they are allowed simply to be, free from pressure to perform and free from roles. Here, the inner landscape can be explored and a fresh vision discovered. Here, we return to what is essential, to what makes us human, to the interconnectedness of all life and the responsibility that arises from it.

Our foremost aim is to cultivate awareness around transformational processes and spiritual emergencies and to support those affected by them. Embedded in everyday communal life, we accompany people through periods of disorientation and upheaval so that crisis becomes

maturation. Integration happens here in relationship and through a return to a natural way of living.

Our vision is a world in which those who have undergone such processes act as *elders* — wise, guiding members of their communities. Each person who experiences deeper integration in our chrysalis carries this transformation back into their environment, creating a ripple effect that shifts collective consciousness. We see ourselves as catalysts for a more conscious future.

At our place, not only humans in distress find an open door; elderly and sick animals who have no place left in the system are also welcome too, not to serve a purpose, but because every life has value. Their presence reminds us of compassion and friendship.

We respect all religions and spiritual paths. Our task is not to instruct participants but to support them in defining and living their own beliefs.

The Crisis of Modernity and the Call for Transformation

Our world is caught in a deep state of forgetting and alienation, resembling a collective psychosis. Within a system built on ruthless exploitation, we destroy the ecosystem and the very foundation of life. Humans and animals alike are trapped in an industrial machinery that leaves little room for dignity, compassion, or self-actualization. This pathological norm is perceived by many as inevitable and natural, eroding our ability even to imagine a healthier, life-affirming world.

Yet more and more people are awakening from this collective sleep. They remember the spiritual ground of all being and recognize that our civilization is not aligned with what is humane or life-supporting. Such awakenings, however, are often explosive and overwhelming. They break apart old structures and plunge individuals into profound disorientation, with no anchor, context or language for what is happening. Awakening turns into *spiritual emergency*.

A *spiritual emergency* refers to a spiritual opening that has become overwhelming and disruptive to life. It is accompanied by psychological disintegration, extreme emotional states, energetic phenomena, and non-ordinary states of consciousness. Although it may resemble mental illness from the outside, it differs fundamentally: when properly supported, such a process can lead to deeper psychological integration, spiritual well-being, and a renewed focus on life, often centered around service to others.

In our society, however, the space, knowledge, and professionals capable of guiding such processes are lacking. Instead of being treated as initiation, a *spiritual emergency* is viewed as pathology and burdened with unnecessary fear and shame. Potential healers, visionaries, and leaders are pathologized, isolated, and suppressed with medication. Failed initiations are tragic not only for the individual who cannot realize their potential but also for the spiritual well-being of the collective, which loses their gifts.

We lack *elders*, people who have themselves walked through the fire of transformation and can offer others support, guidance, and context. Without conscious rites of passage, we remain children in adult bodies or burn up in unaccompanied initiations. In such spiritual immaturity, we act self-centeredly and are unable to care for the well-being of the planet.

Psychedelic Opening: The Risks of Forced Transformation

Today, interest in psychedelics is rising, often coupled with the hope of rapid healing and spiritual insight. When these substances are used outside of ritual contexts and without adequate preparation, integration, or a safe environment, they can easily lead to spiritual emergencies.

Psychedelic substances can forcibly open subtle energy centers (*chakras*) in the body. This often releases enormous amounts of life force faster than body, nervous system, and psyche can manage. Such abrupt activation bypasses natural protective mechanisms that normally ensure inner transformation unfolds at a healthy pace.

What follows a forced opening is inner chaos: worldviews collapse, familiar systems of meaning lose grip. Boundaries between self and world blur, leading to extreme emotional openness and sensory overwhelm. The person becomes flooded with insights they cannot integrate into everyday life. Instead of integration, confusion, manic states, or spiritual bypassing arise. The person enters a liminal state, unable to return to ordinary life, yet not established in a new inner reality.

The body, too, is deeply affected. Emotional and energetic tensions that are not processed become stored in muscles and fascia, manifesting as chronic tightness, pain, and impaired neuromuscular coordination. When hormonal imbalances add to this, a wide spectrum of diffuse physical symptoms can emerge.

Modern medicine has no framework for these states. Symptoms are viewed in isolation, pathologized, and treated incorrectly. This reinforces helplessness and blocks integration.

The *chakra system* here is not seen as a literal description of the energy body but as a spiritual map of processes of consciousness and development. Each *chakra* represents an evolutionary brain circuit mirroring our unfolding from instinct-driven reptilian layers through emotional mammalian structures and role-forming primate patterns to the self-reflective human — and further, toward cosmic consciousness.

Depending on which *chakra* a person's awareness is primarily centered in, identification takes shape. If energy is bound in the root *chakra*, survival dominates. If anchored in the heart, identification widens to all humanity and concern shifts to the well-being of all. In the *crown chakra*, identification with form dissolves entirely: consciousness recognizes itself as pure being, beyond life and death.
Importantly, the *chakras* do not represent a hierarchy of "higher" or "lower." Each *chakra's* function is essential for the optimal functioning of the individual, just as a complex society needs people operating from diverse layers of consciousness.

Our Understanding of Therapy

Integration in Community

We are not a traditional clinic but a therapeutic community in which relationship, meaningful everyday life, and a natural lifestyle take priority. Recovery begins where people feel safe, seen, and valued, not in clinical structures and treatment plans.

Instead of adopting roles of "therapist" and "patient," we meet each other as equals. We do not believe diagnoses or medication are inherently helpful, in fact, they can disempower, stigmatize, and intensify crises. We therefore avoid pathologizing systems and therapeutic interventions. What matters in navigating crisis is not what a state is named but whether meaning and hope can be found.

We do not categorically reject psychiatric medication or psychotherapeutic interventions. There are situations in which temporary use is appropriate, for example, when behavior threatens the person's life or the safety of others. Abrupt discontinuation of neuroleptics after long-term use can lead to severe side effects that worsen or even induce psychotic states. In such cases, psychiatric support is essential to prevent further destabilization.

Active participation in community life is central to our approach. Everyday activities such as cooking, cleaning, gardening, caring for animals, playing, or hiking foster a salutary sense of connection and safety. The nervous system regulates when attention shifts from internal overwhelm to the tangible solidity of the outer world. This lived relationship between residents and clients, together with grounding of awareness, forms our actual therapy.

Our therapeutic model is inspired by the *Soteria movement*, which emerged in the 1970s from the anti-psychiatry movement. The term *Soteria* means "salvation," "safety," or "wholeness." It describes an alternative form of support for people with schizophrenia focused on a therapeutic community and minimal use of medication. It aims to accompany individuals through psychosis within a true-to-life environment and through active participation. Today, clinics around with *Soteria-projects*, as well as clinics that integrate *Soteria-elements* into their everyday treatment exist around the world.

Personal Responsibility in the Integration Process

We invite clients to take active responsibility for their crisis story. What counts as a "healthy" experience is culturally defined; there is no right or wrong interpretation of spiritual events. What matters is the meaning the individual assigns to it and the transformation that becomes possible. Our role is to support with deep interest in their inner experience, with compassion, and when needed, with tools and maps.

We trust that each person, when feeling safe and supported, possesses the inner resources and intuitive guidance to grow through crisis. Integration is not adaptation to a sick world but embodiment of one's essence and the cultivation of personal gifts.

Connection as a Basic Human Need

Many psychological crises arise or worsen through social isolation. Human connection is a fundamental need rooted deeply in our psyche and biology. We are social beings who need to be seen, to belong, and to contribute. Without the presence and reflection of others, we cannot fully know ourselves. A transparent and compassionate exchange that doesn't shy away from

conflict, is central to our daily interactions. A particularly effective method that helps foster this kind of connection and self-awareness is *Circling.*

> *Circling* is a practice of radical presence in which people meet each other with honesty, deep attentiveness, and non-judgmental reflection. Participants focus on what is happening in the present moment between them, like feelings, impulses, projections, assumptions. By expressing immediate experience, misunderstandings dissolve, understanding and connection grow, and meditative presence is cultivated. This creates a safe space for self-exploration and transformation.

The Core Community

The core community consists of process facilitators who live permanently at the Oasis. They have themselves undergone deep transformational experiences and integrated them, enabling them to accompany others with compassion into the depths they have explored within. Their presence serves as a living reminder that integration and renewal are possible.

Formal psychotherapy or psychiatry training is not required. What matters is personal experience, inner stability, empathy, and a sincere wish to be a supportive force in another's process. Professional training often introduces interpretive frameworks and diagnoses that can hinder active, non-judgmental participation, shifting the relationship into analysis instead of compassion.

To ensure intensive, personal companionship and to protect the private life of the core community, we limit retreat participation to four people at a time. They stay in separate cabins outside the main residence. Spaces used by clients, like bathrooms, community kitchen, art studio or yoga hall, are also located outside the private living area of the core community.

Not every resident's role requires intense contact with clients. Roles vary according to personal strengths and interests, such as:

- Support person (psychological support, yoga therapy)
- Guidance in gardening and animal care
- Daily organization
- Recreational activities
- Art and music therapy support

Flexible Offering

Depending on need and capacity, stays range from three weeks to three months. Entry dates are flexible and not tied to group cycles. To keep retreats accessible, we offer a contribution-based model: with three hours of additional daily participation (e.g., gardening, maintenance), accommodation and all services are covered. Participants only pay for food. This model is limited to one person at a time and three weeks maximum.

For those unable to withdraw from everyday life for long periods, we also offer workshops and seminars. These serve both individuals seeking orientation and medical professionals wishing to learn how to recognize and safely accompany psychospiritual crises. Our goal is to empower people to take responsibility for their integration rather than be misdiagnosed, mistreated, or misled by false promises.

The Oasis follows an annual cycle: eight months for retreats, followed by two months of workshops and two months of rest. This protects the private life, psychological balance, and resilience of residents.

Our offering is exclusively for people in psychospiritual crises. We do not treat schizophrenia and cannot accept individuals in psychopharmacological treatment for psychotic conditions. We are not a clinic and do not have the professional training or infrastructure required for severe psychiatric illness.

Natural Living as the Basis for Integration

Another core aspect of our understanding of integration is reconnection with the biological foundations of the body. We trust in the natural intelligence and self-regulating capacity of both body and mind. When the right inner and outer environment is provided, deep homeostasis and natural self-healing capabilities can re-establish themselves, often resulting in spontaneous regeneration without major intervention.

Much of modern suffering arises from the evolutionary mismatch between contemporary life and the natural conditions our organism evolved for. Integration therefore includes restoring those conditions under which life originally thrived.

Elements woven into daily life include:

- **Natural, mineral-rich nutrition** — adapted to individual needs rather than dietary dogma
- **Fresh air** — outdoor activity to enliven the organism
- **Pure spring water** — foundation for all cellular and organ functions
- **Sunlight** — exposure on bare skin to harmonize hormonal and immune processes
- **Movement** — supporting lymphatic flow, circulation, and mood
- **Electromagnetic hygiene** — mindful technology use to protect biological rhythms and reduce overstimulation
- **Restorative sleep and rest** — prerequisites for all regeneration
- **Earthing** — full-body contact with the earth to balance electrical charge and release excess energy

Yoga Therapy as a Path of Regeneration

We use an innovative form of yoga therapy specialized in harmonizing dysregulated *Kundalini* processes, especially those triggered prematurely or forcefully through psychedelics or wrong spiritual practice. The aim of this method is not to control the process but to reduce the immense strain an active *Kundalini* has on a system that is not prepared to hold the heightened charge. This is done by aligning the process with natural biological rhythms and turning the body into a strong vessel that can properly conduct *Kundalini.* At the same time this work helps to build a stable foundation for deeper spiritual development.

Our approach integrates cellular detoxification, nervous system stabilization, muscular-fascial restructuring, and awareness training with targeted lifestyle interventions into a biologically grounded process. No prior yoga experience is needed for it to be effective, only patience and

willingness to take full responsibility for one's integration. Nor are radical lifestyle changes a prerequisite. Rather, the method is adapted to the individual constitution, life circumstances, and personal capacities.

Kundalini is a metaphor for the hidden human potential and the evolutionary intelligence underlying all life. In yogic philosophy, it is described as a serpent resting in the root chakra. Traditional yoga aims to prepare the individual over a lifetime for the awakening of this latent power and its movement from the root to the *crown chakra*, culminating in cosmic consciousness.

Kundalini is understood here as a bioenergetic remolding that profoundly changes the nervous system, hormonal balance, and musculoskeletal structure, while also resolving emotional trauma, dissolving unconscious defenses, and transforming perception of self and world. Old identities dissolve, and life reorients radically.

Psychologically, *Kundalini* can be understood as a deep developmental impulse mobilizing the entire personality. This impulse urges authenticity, making the unconscious conscious and orienting life toward expression of one's individual essence.

Intensity and characteristics vary depending on surrender, unresolved trauma, emotional blockages, and physical imbalances stored in the system. When energy meets resistance, intense physical, psychological, and energetic symptoms may arise. What feels like chaos is in truth deep systemic reorganization toward greater coherence.

This biological understanding demystifies *Kundalini* and enables better regulation and management of symptoms. They are no longer seen as pathological or signs of spiritual failure, reducing fear and fostering trust in the natural unfolding.

A *Kundalini awakening* marks the initial activation of this force. Depending on predisposition and inner resistance, the process may be smooth and harmonious, or intense, disruptive, and chaotic. Awakening is not an endpoint but the beginning of a lifelong deepening of awareness and individuation. It is like a rhythmic pulse guiding us through valleys and peaks of our being, repeatedly demanding that we shed old skin and outgrow limitations.

As an integral therapy, it works with all layers of human existence (*koshas)*. First, the outer *koshas* are stabilized to prepare the system for safe work with the inner *koshas*. The process follows the client's pace and readiness, ensuring that each step is genuinely integrated and resistance is avoided. Somatic trauma work and meditation are introduced only in the advanced stages of treatment.

This approach is not merely a set of practices but a way of living and relating to being, empowering us to realize hidden potential and live in greater harmony. It is essential not to expect immediate results but to progress step by step. Nature follows its own rhythm, and true change requires patience and self-responsibility. Only those who commit actively and long-term will experience lasting transformation.

Yogic philosophy views the human as a multi-layered being, represented by the *Panchakosha model* (five bodies or sheaths). Each sheath expresses a dimension of our existence, from physical to the subtlest layers of consciousness. These layers shape experience and simultaneously veil the radiant essence at our core. When they are in harmony, a natural state of wholeness, vitality, and inner freedom emerges.

Health challenges are rarely one-dimensional. Illness typically manifests along an energetic continuum: beginning as subtle disharmony or misalignment and crystallizing into gross physical symptoms. The *kosha model* helps illuminate the complexity of human suffering and offers multiple avenues for integration, whereas many conventional approaches focus solely on the outermost expression of disease. This symptom-oriented lens may suppress or shift symptoms without reaching the deeper roots of imbalance.

The five sheaths are interwoven; disturbance in one inevitably affects the others. All layers must be tended so that life can be experienced in its fullness. The deepest transformations arise when practice touches the subtler *koshas*, especially *Vijnanamaya* (the sheath of insight) and *Anandamaya* (the sheath of bliss). Access to these realms requires maturity and inner stability; without this foundation, the process cannot unfold safely or sustainably.

Our Offer

Retreats

- **Spiritual Emergency:** In the disorientation, openness, and vulnerability of a *spiritual emergency*, a retreat offers a protected environment in which individuals must only manage the essentials, held by a compassionate and understanding setting. This space does not aim to restore “functionality” quickly or define the experience but allows the process to unfold organically. This refuge acts as a *Chrysalis*: a transitional space where new inner and outer boundaries can emerge without being crushed by everyday pressures.
- **Vision Quest:** We view illness as a signal from the soul that we have strayed from our path. Integration is not found in symptom management but in remembering our essence and realizing our qualities and gifts. Humans have a fundamental need to contribute to the web of life. When we embody our unique purpose, attention shifts from the small self and its suffering to the well-being of the whole. Through this expansion, symptoms such as fear and depression often dissolve naturally, and remaining difficulties no longer prevent active participation in life.

Seminars and Workshops

- **Transformational Pedagogy:** Understanding processes of transformation and spiritual crisis
- **Yoga Therapy:** Practical methods and lifestyle interventions to regulate activated *Kundalini*
- **Psychological Work:** Integration of psychedelic experiences, process work, psychodrama, somatic experiencing, and more — offered by trained professionals

Social Café and Peer Support

One day per week we open our doors and offer a space where people can connect, share stories and experiences, learn from each other, and meet in presence and awareness. Many undergoing intense awakening remain invisible to society, others, and sometimes themselves. They often hear voices from the outside that diminish or pathologize their experience, weakening trust in their own perception. A network that normalizes these experiences, restores self-confidence, and nurtures hope for integration is therefore essential.

We also provide a platform for artists and visionaries to share their work with others.

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Author: Nils Föge